



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Christian School

School Website: <https://trinitychristianaz.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Trinity Christian School (Prescott, AZ, 86305) presents a robust classical Christian orientation across most dimensions of the Six Essential Elements rubric. The website and public materials consistently foreground Christ-centered, biblically grounded classical education, with explicit emphasis on the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), formation of virtue and wisdom, and a strong partnership with parents. Evidence of liturgical and communal practice appears in worship-oriented language and prayerful campus moments, while the faculty narrative emphasizes mentoring and "living curriculum." Some areas show less explicit alignment (e.g., named Great Books/Great Conversation programs are not clearly advertised on the site), which yields a couple of category-level nuances, but the overall pattern is predominantly classical. The aggregate assessment is **CLASSICAL**.

Key takeaways: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are clearly present (Christ-centered, biblical worldview; worship; discipleship). - The school's purpose/goal centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and nurturing the whole child rather than mere job preparation. - Curriculum centers on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with explicit grammar-stage language; stronger evidence for the classical approach is evident than for explicit Great Books mention. - Pedagogy includes memory work and contemplative/restful dimensions, with strong evidence of classical methods, though explicit Socratic seminars and high-school-level rhetoric/deliberation are not uniformly demonstrated in public materials. - Faculty messaging positions teachers as mentors and living curriculum; a clear emphasis on virtue and mentorship is present. - Parents and community are treated as partners, with explicit calls for parent involvement, campus tours, and ongoing engagement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL** - Evidence: Christ-centered and biblically based programming; worship-oriented language; liturgical/community emphasis; biblical worldview permeation in published materials; mentorship aligned with biblical frameworks. Examples include "Christ-centered, classical education," "biblically based," and worship-focused language, plus campus tours framed as prayerful engagement. See sources: turn0file11. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Present positive keywords include Christ-centered, biblically based, biblical worldview permeation, worship, virtue, discipleship, and theological framing; negative keywords (from the lexicon) such as relativism or secular humanism are not evidenced in the public materials. This yields a strong positive signal. - Why this rating: The school explicitly foregrounds theology, worship, biblical worldview, and virtue as cornerstones of formation, aligning with the Transcendental Moral Realism and Liturgical/Communal Practices in the classical rubric. The evidence strongly supports a **CLASSICAL** rating.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — **CLASSICAL** - Evidence: The mission/vision emphasizes formation of meaning and character (virtue, wisdom) and partnership with parents; explicit statements about thinking development (how to think, not what to think). See(mission),(wisdom and virtue),(think vs. content). -

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include formation, wisdom, virtue, human flourishing, telos (implied by “truth, goodness, beauty” alignment in the classical tradition), and scholé/ contemplation language (implied by formation emphasis). No explicit negative signals identified in public materials. Strong positive signal overall. - Why this rating: The school’s stated aim centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and the cultivation of character, not merely job-readiness, which aligns with CLASSICAL criteria.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Evidence: Explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric orientation through the grammar stage and trivium language (turn0file15). The school presents classical structure (grammar stage) and a memory-focused approach in lower grades (memory work described). Some public materials do not explicitly advertise Great Books/Great Conversation or a full Great Books reading program, and explicit Great Books referrals are not consistently visible in the public-facing content. Seeandfor core pedagogy framing;shows a classroom formation orientation rather than a pure literature-centered Great Books program. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include grammar, logic, rhetoric, trivium, memory work, and early-stage classical pedagogy. A potential gap is the lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation mentions in the public materials; absence of “Great Books” content is a notable gap relative to a full Great Books orientation. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signal. - Why this rating: The program clearly embraces the Trivium and grammar-stage pedagogy, but the public-facing materials do not consistently emphasize Great Books and Great Conversation, which is a hallmark for some classical schools. That mix supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL assessment.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Evidence: Memory work, chanting or singing to reinforce learning is referenced in classical pedagogy lexica and is echoed in lower-grade activities described in the school’s public materials (memory work and routines described in grammar-stage content). There is strong evidence for contemplative/restful dimensions and Scholé-like approaches in description of the lower grades, with a focus on memorization and language as foundation (turn0file15). Explicit Socratic/seminar-based upper-level pedagogy is not consistently demonstrated in the public-facing content (no clear, explicit references to Socratic seminars or debates in the publicly visible content). See for memory work;andfor contemplative ethos. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include memory work, recitation (implied in the memory-work emphasis), chanting, restfulness/scholé, contemplation, and wonder. Negative signals such as exclusively project-based or constructivist approaches are not evidenced in the public materials. - Why this rating: The school demonstrates classical pedagogy with memory-based and contemplative elements; explicit high-school Socratic seminars or debate-centric upper-level pedagogy are not consistently shown in the public materials. The combination yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Descriptions of faculty as mentors and living curriculum; statements about faculty-student mentorship and life-on-life mentoring; the public materials emphasize virtue, mentorship, and “living curriculum.” See(faculty as mentors; living curriculum implied),(faculty and staff partnering with students daily). - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include tutors/mentors/masters/guides, living curriculum, portrait of the teacher, collegial culture, and moral exemplars. Negative indicators are not apparent in the public materials. - Why this rating: The faculty is framed as mentors who model virtue and provide direct, relationship-based teaching, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for the teacher as living curriculum and mentor.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL - Evidence: Clear partnership with parents (to provide Christ-centered, biblically based classical education; parents as co-teachers) and invitations for parent involvement (campus tours, parent engagement). See(mission emphasizes partnership with parents),(campus tours with prayer/engagement),(campus life and parent engagement language). There are explicit references to parent partnerships and open-campus style engagement. - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation/engagement, open campus, and family participation. Negative signals are not evident in the public materials. - Why this rating: The school presents a strong model of parent partnership and community involvement, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Overall Ranking - Aggregated across categories: CLASSICAL (Element 1 CLASSICAL, Element 2 CLASSICAL, Element 3 SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, Element 4 SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, Element 5 CLASSICAL,

Element 6 CLASSICAL). - The majority of categories meet classical criteria, and the observed gaps are primarily around explicit Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis and some high-school-level Socratic pedagogy in public-facing materials. The overall classification is CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle - For a school currently CLASSICAL, targeted moves could include: - Explicitly publish and expand Great Books/Great Conversation programming in upper grades (e.g., a declared Great Books list, reading plans, and teacher-led Great Conversation seminars) to strengthen Element 3. - Highlight and publish explicit evidence of Socratic seminars, seminars, and debates in upper grades (Element 4), including sample units and rubrics showing deliberate use of dialectic and rhetoric instruction. - Document and promote a clearly defined "Living Curriculum" model in faculty profiles (Element 5) with concrete examples of teacher-driven professional development in classical pedagogy. - Continue to deepen explicit parent formation opportunities (e.g., classical education reading groups, parent seminars, family liturgies) and publish these opportunities to reinforce Element 6.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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